

São Tomé & Príncipe

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** November 5, 1975 **Usage:** National and Civil

The red triangle recalls the struggle for independence, as on the flags of Ghana and Togo



Green, red, yellow, and black are pan-African colors

The two stars stand for the two islands

Africa



São Tomé & Príncipe are a pair of islands in the Gulf of Guinea that formerly belonged to Portugal. They became independent in 1975.

The flag is based on the party flag of the Movement for the Liberation of São Tomé & Príncipe (MLSTP). It was retained even after the party lost its monopoly of power in 1990.

The combination of red, yellow, and green with black stars, is clearly based on the flag of Ghana, with the stars standing for the two islands.

The shield within the national arms is in the form of a cocoa pod, on which is depicted a cocoa palm, the country's main export. Above this is a star representing freedom. The supporters are two pigeons standing on a scroll with the national motto—"Unidade, Disciplina, Trabalho" ("Unity, Discipline, Work").

ARMS OF SÃO TOMÉ & PRÍNCIPE

The crest, a blue star, stands for African freedom

The shield is in the form of a cocoa pod



The upper scroll bears the title of the state

The national motto—"Unidade, Disciplina, Trabalho" ("Unity, Discipline, Work")